



TAKING OFF

There were a few technologies that needed to be mastered before man himself could go to space. And yes, monkeys and dogs have been there first!

Before sending man into space, there was the obvious problem of building a machine that managed to break out of the Earth's cocoon of spheres and go beyond. While the first human space-flight wouldn't happen until 1961, the stepping stones were laid down from as early as 50 years before that.

Much like any great scientific achievement, the inspiration for it drew from fiction. In 1898, H. G. Wells published the much-acclaimed sci-fi novel *The War Of The Worlds*. Among its many fans was a young American physics student, Robert Goddard. Goddard went on to study the mechanics of rockets and was the first to suggest the idea of a liquid-fuelled rocket in